
Preface

Language has been integral to human society for thousands of years. A long-prevailing theory, laryngeal descent theory or LDT, suggests that speech and, thus, language, may have evolved about 200,000 or 300,000 years ago, while newer research shows it could've happened [even sooner](#).

Regardless of when it first appeared, language remains the cornerstone of human communication. It has taken on an even greater role in today's digital age, where an unprecedented portion of the population can communicate via both text and speech across the globe.

This is underscored by the fact that 347.3 billion [email messages](#) are sent and received worldwide every day, and that five billion people – or over 63% of the entire world population – send and receive [text messages](#).

Language has therefore become a vast trove of information that can help enterprises extract valuable insights, identify trends, and make informed decisions. As an example, enterprises can analyze texts like customer reviews to identify their products' best-selling features and fine-tune their future product development.

Similarly, language production – as opposed to language *analysis* – is also becoming an increasingly important tool for enterprises. Creating blog posts, for example, can help enterprises raise brand awareness to a previously unheard-of extent, while composing emails can help them attract new stakeholders or partners at an unmatched speed.

However, both language analysis and production are time-consuming processes that can distract employees and decision-makers from more important tasks. For instance, leaders often need to sift through vast amounts of text in order to make informed decisions instead of making them based on extracted key information.

Enterprises can minimize these and other problems, such as the risk of human error, by employing **large language models (LLMs)** for language-related tasks. LLMs can help enterprises accelerate and largely *automate* their efforts related to both language production and analysis, saving valuable time and resources while improving accuracy and efficiency.

Unlike previous solutions, such as rule-based systems, LLMs are incredibly versatile and can be easily adapted to a wide range of language-related tasks, like generating content or summarizing legal documentation.